Skills development for managing longitudinal data for sharing: A showcase of training resources created for the longitudinal population studies data managers community

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1 ESRC and MRC-funded training initiative (a PRUK foundation project)

This initiative, a foundation project of Population Research UK (PRUK) aims to support data professionals in managing and sharing longitudinal research data.

Free, open-licensed training materials created by UK Data Service are available to help improve data management practices and data-sharing strategies.

Visit the PRUK Hub. An initiative dedicated to unlocking the potential of the UK's longitudinal population studies across social, economic, and biomedical research.

2 Developing effective training workshops

A survey of the LPS data management community identified a need for tiered training.

Core topics included data cleaning and file management, and advanced skills included disclosure risk assessment and data harmonisation.

12 introductory and focused workshops were designed and delivered.

3 Key core training topics

1. Welcome and introduction
Provides an introduction to the course, its objectives, and its context within the Population Research UK initiative.

2. Foundational concepts in data management
Covers foundational concepts in research data management, including the data lifecycle and the FAIR data principles.

3. Ethical and legal considerations in handling longitudinal research data
Discusses ethical and legal considerations in handling longitudinal research data, including data protection laws and participant privacy.

4. Strategies and best practices for organising and formatting data
Explores best practices for organising and formatting data, including file versioning, metadata, and quality assurance.

5. Effective methods and practices for documenting data
Details effective methods for documenting data, emphasising FAIR compliance and study-level documentation.

6. Techniques and guidelines for anonymising data
Provides guidelines for anonymising data while preserving its research value, including techniques for handling direct and indirect identifiers.

7. Data sharing strategies. Overview and recommendations
Outlines strategies for sharing data responsibly, focusing on the use of trusted repositories, FAIR principles, and ethical considerations.

4 Focused sessions

Introduction to Synthetic Data for Longitudinal Data Managers

Transforming data management with the Harmony Data Tool: A hands-on introduction

5 Continuous improvement through feedback and evaluation

311 data managers and professionals completed training between June and October 2024, helping to strengthen research data management across the community and improve data sharing.

Feedback helped refine materials for clarity, relevance, and practical application.

Content evolved to meet the changing needs of the LPS community.

6 Creating reusable and adaptable resources

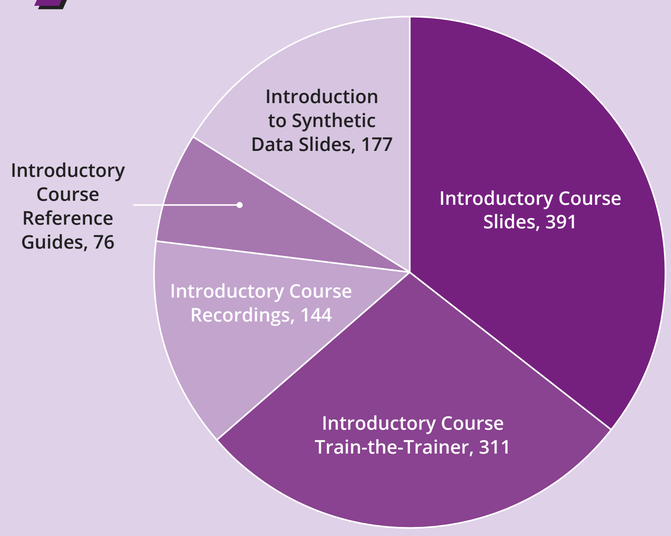
Course slides	Train-the-trainer	Recordings
• Presentation slides for each session of the course, including interactive activities.	• Presentation slides with comprehensive speaker notes to facilitate delivery.	• Structured video recordings to complement the finalised course materials.

Training materials are open-access under Creative Commons licensing.

Resources support self-paced learning and trainer-led sessions.

Includes presentations, structured exercises, and practical examples.

7 Maximising impact and outreach



Final resources promoted via a UKDS news story, CLOSER Training Hub, and PRUK community on Zenodo.

Downloaded 1,099 times and viewed over 2,000 times (November 2024 – March 2025).

Access, use and adapt the resources

Scan the QR code to explore the resources on the PRUK community on Zenodo.

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